

SELF & OTHERS

SONDIM
FOUNDER
COACHING

THE CORE STRUGGLE

This area concerns your capacity to be with yourself and others without needing anyone to change[cite: 7]. You might be constantly in motion because stillness feels dangerous, leading to a feeling that the present moment is never enough[cite: 7].

These patterns stem from a belief that you are not good enough to be accepted as you are, which originated as a survival strategy but now blocks deep connection[cite: 7].

THE COST OF DISCONNECTION

When disconnected, your relationships may feel superficial despite wanting more depth, and you may feel lonely even when with people[cite: 7]. It often feels safer to focus on others' opinions rather than your own truth[cite: 7].

At work, this manifests as overthinking, disengaging, or becoming aggressive during hard conversations instead of being honest[cite: 7].

PATTERNS TO EXPLORE

PEOPLE-PLEASING

When you focus on managing how others see you by avoiding conflict, you lose contact with your own truth[cite: 7]. This leads people to connect with a performance, preventing deep connection[cite: 7].

HIDDEN AGENDAS

Steering a conversation toward an outcome—like trying to make someone change—creates resistance[cite: 7]. People feel unspoken agendas, and releasing them allows real connection to emerge[cite: 7].

RIGID THINKING

Fear of judgment collapses openness[cite: 7]. We shift into black-and-white thinking to defend ourselves[cite: 7]. Recognizing this rigid thinking is a clear signal that fear is currently present[cite: 7].

YOUR EXPERIMENT

When discussing a challenging situation where you want to offer an opinion or jump to a conclusion, ask questions starting with "How" or "What" instead[cite: 7].

OPTION 1: PRACTICE WITH A PARTNER

OR OPTION 2

THE HOW & WHAT FRAMEWORK

TIME: ONGOING

STEP 1: PAUSE

When you feel the urge to offer an unsolicited opinion or jump to a conclusion, stop yourself before speaking[cite: 7].

STEP 2: ASK "WHAT"

Use "what" to seek clarity. E.g., "What was your thinking behind executing that task without talking about it?"[cite: 7].

STEP 3: ASK "HOW"

Use "how" to collaborate. E.g., "How do we set up a world so that neither of us feels badly about this again?"[cite: 7].